



Personal Safety & Social Responsibilities (PSSR)

116 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

Updated for DG Shipping India Exams | Source: brightmariner.com

Practice Set 1

Q1. How can information regarding a sick person or injured person be disseminated to the CIRM?

- A) By using the appropriate reporting form
- B) By contacting the family doctor of the sick person
- C) By passing on medical examination report from the company
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: A (By using the appropriate reporting form)

Explanation: CIRM (Centro Internazionale Radio Medico) or similar telemedical assistance services require specific medical reporting forms to provide accurate diagnosis and treatment advice for sick or injured personnel.

Q2. Loose gear should be lashed in front of the freezing ports so it will not roll about the decks.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: False. Loose gear must always be securely lashed in a manner that prevents it from shifting, especially in heavy weather, to avoid damage or potential injuries to the crew.

Q3. If you saw wisps of smoke coming out under the engine room door, you immediately:

- A) Raise the alarm
- B) Activate the fixed fire fighting system
- C) Shut off the main fuel supply
- D) Close the air vents

Correct Answer: A (Raise the alarm)

Explanation: Raising the alarm is the mandatory first step to initiate emergency response procedures, ensuring the bridge, engine room, and crew are alerted to the situation immediately.

Q4. Life jacket should be marked with the:

- A) Maximum weight allowed
- B) Stowage space assigned
- C) Vessel's home port
- D) Vessel's name

Correct Answer: D (Vessel's name)

Explanation: SOLAS requires that life-saving appliances, including life jackets, are clearly marked with the vessel's name to ensure identification and return to the parent ship during rescue operations.

Q5. What is the life-saving signal at day for "you are seen-assistance will be given as soon as possible"?

Personal Safety & Social Responsibilities (PSSR) Exit Exam Prep

brightmariner.com



- A) Green star rocket
- B) Red star rocket
- C) Orange smoke signal
- D) Horizontal motion of a flag

Correct Answer: C (Orange smoke signal)

Explanation: Orange smoke signals are recognized international life-saving signals used during the day to indicate that the survivor has been spotted and assistance is underway.

Q6. The receiver misunderstands the sender's message and:

- A) This could lead to effective communication
- B) This could lead to a barrier to effective communication
- C) This could lead to wonderful communication

Correct Answer: B (This could lead to a barrier to effective communication)

Explanation: Misinterpretation of messages represents a significant communication barrier, potentially leading to confusion, operational errors, and compromised safety on board.

Q7. Empathetic listening helps you to:

- A) Improve mutual understanding and trust
- B) Improve mutual understanding
- C) Improve mutual understanding and feeling
- D) Improve trust and friendship

Correct Answer: A (Improve mutual understanding and trust)

Explanation: Empathetic listening involves active engagement with the speaker, which fosters trust and improves mutual understanding between crew members, enhancing effective teamwork.

Q8. The problem of misunderstanding can be eliminated by providing ____ to the clients while explaining the process.

- A) Examples
- B) Theories
- C) Sample

Correct Answer: A (Examples)

Explanation: Providing practical examples when explaining complex processes ensures that the listener can visualize and better grasp the concept, thereby reducing the risk of misunderstanding.

Q9. Name two officers who liaise with each other to try out the steering gear:

- A) Chief engineer and chief officer
- B) Second engineer and second officer
- C) Third engineer and third officer

Correct Answer: C (Third engineer and third officer)

Explanation: The testing of steering gear is a critical procedure that requires the Third Officer (on the bridge) and Third Engineer (in the steering gear flat) to coordinate via communication systems.



- A) Tedious
- B) Slower
- C) Faster

Correct Answer: B (Slower)

Explanation: Human cognitive speed, or the rate of thought, is significantly faster than the rate of speech, which is why active listening is essential to maintain focus during verbal exchanges.

Q11. In the verbal communication process, the direct exchange of _____ occurs between the sender and the receiver.

- A) Mails
- B) Words
- C) Gestures

Correct Answer: B (Words)

Explanation: Verbal communication relies on the direct exchange of spoken words to convey information, instructions, or intent between the sender and the receiver.

Q12. What is discrimination?

- A) Making false statements about others
- B) Making judgments or statements based upon comparison
- C) Judging people discriminately
- D) Making hateful content

Correct Answer: B (Making judgments or statements based upon comparison)

Explanation: Discrimination refers to the act of making unjust or prejudicial distinctions between people based on characteristics, which is prohibited in a professional maritime environment.

Q13. What governs safe procedures at work?

- A) The International Convention on Standards of Training, Certification, and Watchkeeping (STCW)
- B) International Safety Management (ISM) Code
- C) Occupational Safety and Health Act (OSHA)
- D) The Code of Safe Working Practices

Correct Answer: D (The Code of Safe Working Practices)

Explanation: The Code of Safe Working Practices for Merchant Seafarers (COSWP) is the primary document providing guidance on safety management and safe work procedures on board ships.

Q14. How do you combat harassment?

- A) By being assertive
- B) By reporting harassing behavior to your superiors
- C) By confronting the harasser

Correct Answer: B (By reporting harassing behavior to your superiors)

Explanation: Reporting harassing behavior through the established chain of command or designated company procedures is the professional and required way to address and combat harassment.



- A) Taking authority
- B) Taking responsibility
- C) Effective communication

Correct Answer: C (Effective communication)

Explanation: Effective communication is widely regarded as the cornerstone of leadership, as it enables the clear transfer of intent, instructions, and feedback to the team.

Q16. "Human elements" in a ship means:

- A) Human behavior
- B) Human relationship
- C) Human interaction
- D) Human error

Correct Answer: D (Human error)

Explanation: Human elements refer to the study of factors, including human error, that influence the performance and safety of personnel working within a technical and high-pressure environment.

Q17. The windlass is located at:

- A) The stern of the ship
- B) The forecastle of the ship
- C) Amidships
- D) The engine room

Correct Answer: B (The forecastle of the ship)

Explanation: The windlass is the heavy-duty machinery located on the forecastle (foredeck) of the ship, used for operating the anchors and mooring lines.

Q18. Displacement refers to the:

- A) Cubic capacity of a vessel
- B) Deadweight carrying capacity of a vessel
- C) Gross tonnage of a vessel
- D) Number of long tons of water displaced by a vessel afloat

Correct Answer: D (Number of long tons of water displaced by a vessel afloat)

Explanation: Displacement is defined by Archimedes' principle as the weight of the water displaced by the hull of a vessel, which is equivalent to the ship's total weight.

Q19. What term indicates an inward curvature of the ship's hull above the waterline?

- A) Camber
- B) Tumblehome
- C) Deadrise
- D) Flare

Correct Answer: B (Tumblehome)

Explanation: Tumblehome describes a ship's hull design where the beam decreases as one moves upward from the waterline toward the deck, creating an inward curvature.



- A) More complex to operate
- B) Less complex to operate
- C) As large as oil tankers
- D) Capable of carrying only one grade of chemical

Correct Answer: A (More complex to operate)

Explanation: Chemical tankers are more complex to operate due to the specialized requirements for cargo compatibility, stringent safety protocols, and the hazardous nature of various chemicals carried.

Q21. In the concept of ship handling, what would be the definition of shallow water?

- A) Water depth of less than twice a vessel's draft
- B) Water depth of less than 1-1/2 times a vessel's draft
- C) Under keel clearance of twice a vessel's draft
- D) Under keel clearance of less than 10 feet

Correct Answer: B (Water depth of less than 1-1/2 times a vessel's draft)

Explanation: In maritime ship handling, shallow water is generally defined as a depth less than 1.5 times the ship's draft, where hydrodynamic effects like squat become significant.

Q22. Which engineering staff is in charge of engine room maintenance?

- A) 2nd engineer
- B) Chief engineer
- C) 3rd engineer
- D) Master

Correct Answer: A (2nd engineer)

Explanation: The Second Engineer is typically responsible for the day-to-day maintenance of engine room machinery, under the overall supervision of the Chief Engineer.

Q23. Physical stress:

- A) Rarely causes emotional stress
- B) Is often a symptom of emotional stress
- C) Rarely is connected to diet
- D) Is often found in people who exercise regularly

Correct Answer: B (Is often a symptom of emotional stress)

Explanation: Physical stress is often the physiological manifestation of unresolved emotional or psychological strain. When the body undergoes prolonged stress, it triggers symptoms like tension headaches, fatigue, or high blood pressure, effectively acting as an indicator of underlying emotional stressors.

Q24. Self-induced stress is mainly due to:

- A) Family
- B) Personality
- C) Economy
- D) Health

Correct Answer: B (Personality)

Explanation: Self-induced stress arises from an individual's internal psychological makeup, including their personality traits, perception of events, and behavioral patterns. Unlike external factors like economy or family, these are internalized responses that determine how one reacts to challenges.



- A) Identifying sources of stress
- B) Being practical
- C) Taking control
- D) Coping with stress

Correct Answer: C (Taking control)

Explanation: Taking control involves proactive management of one's environment and internal state. By organizing schedules, balancing goals, and regulating emotional responses, an individual asserts agency over their stress levels rather than being a passive recipient of external pressures.

Q26. One of the most important factors determining the success of an organization is:

- A) Effective management
- B) Continuous and positive profits
- C) Performance of its employees
- D) Methods to combat internal personnel stress

Correct Answer: C (Performance of its employees)

Explanation: An organization's success is fundamentally built upon its human capital. While management and profit are essential, the performance, dedication, and competence of the employees are the primary drivers of operational excellence and organizational goals.

Q27. In order to comply with safety policies and procedures, the ship's crew and officers must:

- A) Minimize the use of alcohol
- B) Focus on delivering the ship and cargo at all costs
- C) Stop unsafe practices which may cause accidents, injury, or environmental pollution

Correct Answer: C (Stop unsafe practices which may cause accidents, injury, or environmental pollution)

Explanation: Maritime safety culture mandates that any practice deemed unsafe must be immediately ceased to prevent accidents or pollution. Following established safety protocols takes precedence over operational speed or commercial pressure to ensure the vessel, crew, and environment remain protected.

Q28. Direct blood contact can occur through all except:

- A) Needle sharing
- B) Transfusion
- C) Sharing of beds
- D) Accident in healthcare settings

Correct Answer: C (Sharing of beds)

Explanation: Direct blood contact usually requires a vector like needles or open wounds. Sharing a bed does not involve the direct exchange of bodily fluids required for bloodborne pathogen transmission, making it an incorrect method of direct blood contact.

Q29. When fuel oil is being topped off during bunkering operations, the tank valve should be closed:

- A) Slowly to prevent surge stresses
- B) To prevent gas from escaping through the pressure-vacuum relief valves
- C) After the shore pumps are stopped
- D) Rapidly to prevent overflow

Correct Answer: A (Slowly to prevent surge stresses)

Explanation: Closing valves slowly is critical during the final stages of bunkering to prevent 'surge' or 'water hammer' effects.



~~Q30. Oil pollution regulations require any transfer or discharge of oil or oily mixtures to be recorded in the:~~

- A) Pollution control record
- B) Bridge log
- C) Oil record book
- D) Master's log

Correct Answer: C (Oil record book)

Explanation: Under MARPOL Annex I, all oil-related operations, including bunker transfers, ballast, and cleaning, must be documented in the Oil Record Book. This is a legal requirement for demonstrating compliance with international pollution prevention standards.

Practice Set 2

Q1. What is the primary safety duty for an individual crew member on board a vessel?

- A) Ensure the absolute safety of personal equipment only
- B) Follow safe working practices and look out for the safety of fellow crew members
- C) Minimize personal workload to avoid exhaustion
- D) Report faults only during official safety committee meetings

Correct Answer: B (Follow safe working practices and look out for the safety of fellow crew members)

Explanation: The primary duty of every seafarer under safety management systems is personal vigilance and the protection of colleagues. Creating a safe work environment requires individual accountability and looking out for the welfare of the team to prevent incidents.

Q2. When finding yourself working in a noise-heavy engine room environment, what protective equipment is considered most necessary?

- A) Eye protection goggles
- B) Fire-retardant safety suit
- C) Ear muffs or ear plugs
- D) High-visibility safety vest

Correct Answer: C (Ear muffs or ear plugs)

Explanation: Noise-heavy environments like engine rooms present a risk of long-term occupational hearing loss. Ear muffs or ear plugs (Personal Protective Equipment) are mandatory to mitigate acoustic damage and comply with noise control regulations.

Q3. If you discover a fire in the engine room or galley space, what should your immediate first step be?

- A) Attempt to extinguish the fire entirely on your own
- B) Locate and read the emergency instruction manual
- C) Report the situation and sound the emergency fire alarm
- D) Evacuate directly to the lifeboat station without notifying anyone

Correct Answer: C (Report the situation and sound the emergency fire alarm)

Explanation: In any emergency, the primary rule is to notify others immediately by sounding the alarm to activate the ship's emergency response team. Attempting to fight a fire alone without assistance is dangerous and violates standard emergency procedures.

Q4. Under Maritime Labour Convention (MLC) standards, what document must be signed by both the seafarer and the shipowner (or representative) outlining employment terms?



- A) Ship's Official Log Book
- B) Seafarer's Employment Agreement (SEA)
- C) Vessel Safety Management Certificate
- D) Port State Control Clearance

Correct Answer: B (Seafarer's Employment Agreement (SEA))

Explanation: The Seafarer's Employment Agreement (SEA) is a mandatory requirement under the Maritime Labour Convention (MLC) 2006. It ensures that the terms of employment, including wages, hours of work, and repatriation rights, are transparently agreed upon by both parties.

Q5. According to international MARPOL regulations designed to control marine pollution, which of the following records is mandatory to log oil-related machinery space operations?

- A) Garbage Record Book
- B) Cargo Manifest Log
- C) Oil Record Book (Part 1)
- D) Deck Movement Log

Correct Answer: C (Oil Record Book (Part 1))

Explanation: MARPOL Annex I requires that every ship of 400 gross tonnage and above carry an Oil Record Book (Part I - Machinery Space Operations). This document records all movements of oil or sludge to verify compliance with international discharge standards.

Q6. To ensure safety and prevent onboard transmission of pathogens, how should specialized bio-medical waste or clinical sharps generated on board be managed?

- A) Flushed directly into the sewage treatment plant
- B) Discarded openly along with general domestic galley waste
- C) Stored securely in dedicated, marked containers for safe disposal shore-side
- D) Thrown directly overboard outside of special areas

Correct Answer: C (Stored securely in dedicated, marked containers for safe disposal shore-side)

Explanation: Bio-medical waste poses a high infection risk and cannot be treated as general waste. It must be segregated, labeled, and stored in dedicated, secure containers on board until it can be safely disposed of at an authorized shore facility.

Q7. Under the International Convention on Standards of Training, Certification and Watchkeeping (STCW), what is the minimum mandatory period of rest required for watchkeeping personnel in any 24-hour period?

- A) 6 hours
- B) 8 hours
- C) 10 hours
- D) 12 hours

Correct Answer: C (10 hours)

Explanation: Under STCW 2010 regulations, seafarers must have at least 10 hours of rest in any 24-hour period, and 77 hours in any 7-day period. These limits are designed to prevent fatigue, which is a leading cause of maritime accidents.

Q8. What is the standard spoken emergency distress signal used over a VHF radio to indicate a vessel is in imminent danger?



- A) Red Alert
- B) Security
- C) Mayday
- D) Pan-Pan

Correct Answer: C (Mayday)

Explanation: Mayday is the internationally recognized distress signal used in voice communications to indicate that a vessel is in grave and imminent danger. It signals the need for immediate assistance from nearby vessels or authorities.

Q9. When rescuing a person from a confined space, what is the absolute priority required to consider the space safe for entry?

- A) Safety lights
- B) Eye protection
- C) Fire retardant gear
- D) Presence of oxygen (safe atmospheric level)

Correct Answer: D (Presence of oxygen (safe atmospheric level))

Explanation: Before entering a confined space, the atmosphere must be verified safe for life support. Oxygen levels, as well as the presence of toxic or flammable gases, must be tested to ensure the space is safe for entry.

Q10. A negative attitude, inability to manage time, and low self-esteem are personal factors that add to seafarer stress. These fall under:

- A) Environmental factors
- B) Emotional factors
- C) Community factors
- D) Personality factors

Correct Answer: D (Personality factors)

Explanation: A negative attitude and low self-esteem are internal psychological attributes. Because these factors originate from within the individual's mental and behavioral framework, they are classified as personality factors that exacerbate stress.

Q11. High concentrations of Hydrogen Sulfide (H_2S) gas are extremely dangerous to personnel because they can:

- A) Cause involuntary skeletal muscle contractions
- B) Paralyze your breathing system
- C) Cause eye inflammation
- D) Cause dizziness

Correct Answer: B (Paralyze your breathing system)

Explanation: Hydrogen Sulfide (H_2S) is a highly toxic, lethal gas. At high concentrations, it acts as a respiratory paralyzer by inhibiting cellular respiration, which can lead to instant collapse and death for the unsuspecting person.



- A) Take routine rounds of the engine room
- B) Stand idle at the control station
- C) Conduct major overhaul repairs of equipment
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: A (Take routine rounds of the engine room)

Explanation: Routine rounds are vital for the watchkeeping engineer to identify abnormalities such as leaks, vibration, or temperature spikes. Constant monitoring ensures that equipment is performing within normal parameters to prevent potential failures.

Q13. What is the fundamental difference between listening and hearing?

- A) Listening is conscious and hearing is mechanical
- B) Listening is natural and hearing is physical
- C) Listening is mechanical and hearing is normal
- D) Listening is conscious and hearing is effortless

Correct Answer: A (Listening is conscious and hearing is mechanical)

Explanation: Hearing is a physiological process of detecting sound vibrations, whereas listening is a conscious, active process of interpreting and understanding those sounds. Effective communication requires listening, not just the physical act of hearing.

Q14. In survival situations, which of the following visual distress signals is explicitly acceptable for daylight use only?

- A) Handheld red flares
- B) Rocket parachute flares
- C) Orange smoke signals
- D) Red aerial stars

Correct Answer: C (Orange smoke signals)

Explanation: Orange smoke signals provide high visibility against the blue sea during daylight. Because they are not luminous, they are ineffective at night, unlike parachute flares, which are designed for both day and night use.

Q15. If you observe a safety or pollution hazard during fuel transfer (bunkering) operations, what is your immediate first action?

- A) Sound the fire alarm
- B) Shut down the transfer operation
- C) Notify the ballast control operator
- D) Wait for the person in charge to act

Correct Answer: B (Shut down the transfer operation)

Explanation: Safety is the highest priority during any transfer operation. If a hazard is spotted, the immediate, mandatory step is to stop the transfer flow to prevent the hazard from escalating into a spill or fire.

Q16. The signal "Pan-Pan" repeated over the radiotelephone indicates what type of message?

- A) Distress
- B) Safety
- C) All Clear
- D) Urgency

Correct Answer: D (Urgency)

Explanation: The Pan-Pan signal is used to alert maritime authorities of an 'urgency' situation that does not rise to the level of



~~Q17. In order to comply with safety policies and procedures, ship crew and officers must:~~

- A) Minimize the use of alcohol on board
- B) Focus on delivering ship and cargo at all costs
- C) Stop unsafe practices which may cause accidents, injury, or environmental pollution
- D) Focus only on commercial requirements

Correct Answer: C (Stop unsafe practices which may cause accidents, injury, or environmental pollution)

Explanation: Safety policies require that all personnel actively stop unsafe practices. This is a core component of the safety management system, ensuring that risks are mitigated before they manifest as injury, damage, or pollution.

Q18. We use gestures in our non-verbal communication in order to convey a message and:

- A) Impress ourselves
- B) Express ourselves
- C) Suppress ourselves
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: B (Express ourselves)

Explanation: Gestures are a form of non-verbal communication that adds emphasis or clarity to a spoken message. They serve as an extension of one's thoughts, helping to express meaning more effectively to the listener.

Q19. If you tend to give lengthy explanations for simple things, your communication message lacks:

- A) Conciseness
- B) Correctness
- C) Consistency
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: A (Conciseness)

Explanation: Conciseness in communication means conveying the necessary information using the fewest words possible. Lengthy explanations often dilute the main point, leading to confusion and potential loss of critical information during an emergency.

Q20. Which of the following statements regarding primary battery cells used on board is correct?

- A) Used primary cells must be discarded after use
- B) Used primary cells can be fully recharged
- C) Used primary cells can be refilled and reused
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: A (Used primary cells must be discarded after use)

Explanation: Primary battery cells are non-rechargeable electrochemical units. Once their chemical potential is depleted, they cannot be restored through charging or refilling and must be disposed of according to the ship's waste management plan.

Q21. Most minor oil product spills occurring during shipboard operations are caused by:

- A) Equipment failure
- B) Human error
- C) Major casualties
- D) Unforeseeable weather conditions

Correct Answer: B (Human error)

Explanation: Most minor spills result from human error-such as forgetting to close a valve or failing to monitor gauges-rather than catastrophic equipment failure. Vigilance and adherence to procedures are the best preventions against these spills.



- A) More complex to operate
- B) Less complex to operate
- C) As large as standard oil tankers
- D) Capable of carrying only one grade of oil

Correct Answer: A (More complex to operate)

Explanation: Chemical tankers carry specialized, hazardous liquid cargoes that require complex systems for temperature control, segregation, and tank cleaning. Consequently, their operation is significantly more complex than that of standard crude oil tankers.

Q23. Which code or document directly governs safe working procedures and routines at work on board a vessel?

- A) STCW Code
- B) ISM Code
- C) Occupational Health Act
- D) Code of Safe Working Practices (COSWP)

Correct Answer: D (Code of Safe Working Practices (COSWP))

Explanation: The Code of Safe Working Practices (COSWP) is the definitive manual for safety procedures and routines for merchant seafarers. It provides the standardized, industry-accepted practices for working safely on deck and in machinery spaces.

Q24. What does the operational maritime acronym RADAR stand for?

- A) Radio Direction and Ranging
- B) Radio Distance and Ranging
- C) Radio Detection and Ranging
- D) Radium Direction and Ranging

Correct Answer: C (Radio Detection and Ranging)

Explanation: RADAR is an acronym for Radio Detection and Ranging. It uses radio waves to determine the bearing, range, and relative speed of objects, which is critical for navigation and collision avoidance at sea.

Q25. The problem of misunderstanding during operational training can be drastically eliminated by providing:

- A) Complex theory
- B) Physical material samples
- C) Practical examples
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Practical examples)

Explanation: Practical examples bridge the gap between theory and application. By showing the crew how to handle equipment or procedures in real-world scenarios, the potential for misunderstanding is minimized through experiential learning.

Q26. When scuppers are plugged and an oil spill occurs on deck during fuel transfer, you should:

- A) Use absorbent material such as sawdust or pads to clean up the spill
- B) Remove the plug from scuppers to allow it to run overboard
- C) Remove scuppers and wash the fuel overboard with chemical solvents
- D) Sound the general emergency alarm immediately

Correct Answer: A (Use absorbent material such as sawdust or pads to clean up the spill)

Explanation: Absorbent materials are the primary defense for containing a minor spill on deck. By preventing the oil from entering the scuppers, you stop the pollutant from entering the marine environment, which is the immediate priority.



- A) Three
- B) Four
- C) Eight
- D) Six

Correct Answer: D (Six)

Explanation: MARPOL (International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships) consists of six technical annexes, each addressing different forms of ship-generated pollution such as oil, chemicals, sewage, garbage, and air emissions.

Q28. In what ways can interpersonal relationships be improved among crew members on board?

- A) Maintaining good communication lines
- B) Developing empathy and understanding with each other
- C) Mutually helping out others during intense workloads
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Interpersonal relationships are strengthened by empathy, good communication, and teamwork. Fostering a supportive environment reduces social isolation and improves collective morale, which is vital for long-term crew cohesion.

Q29. Meteorological warning reports transmitted to the ship consist of one of the following:

- A) Iceberg movement information
- B) Floating debris location
- C) Vessel on fire or sinking tracking
- D) Weather information or severe storm warnings

Correct Answer: D (Weather information or severe storm warnings)

Explanation: Meteorological warnings transmitted via GMDSS/radio provide crucial data about weather patterns and severe storms. This information allows the bridge team to alter course or prepare for heavy weather to ensure vessel safety.

Q30. What is the immediate first action to be taken when you encounter an emergency situation on board?

- A) Muster the crew in the designated area
- B) Sound the ship's emergency alarm
- C) Try to fight the emergency completely on your own
- D) Wait at your position for instructions

Correct Answer: B (Sound the ship's emergency alarm)

Explanation: The ship's emergency alarm is the universal signal to notify the crew of a critical situation. It ensures that everyone is alerted immediately, allowing for a structured response and muster rather than disjointed, individual efforts.

Practice Set 3



- A) Garbage Record Book
- B) Deck Log Book
- C) Engine Log Book
- D) GMDSS Log Book

Correct Answer: D (GMDSS Log Book)

Explanation: The GMDSS (Global Maritime Distress and Safety System) logbook is the official record for all radio communications concerning safety and distress. It must be maintained as required by the SOLAS convention.

Q2. Which of the following jobs on board explicitly requires a Hot Work Permit before execution?

- A) Mopping the accommodation deck
- B) Gas cutting or welding operations on deck
- C) Normal cooking operations in the galley
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: B (Gas cutting or welding operations on deck)

Explanation: Hot work, such as welding or gas cutting, involves high-temperature sources capable of igniting vapors or materials. A permit-to-work system is mandatory to ensure all safety precautions are met before starting the work.

Q3. As per STCW 2010 regulations, what is the maximum validity period of a seafarer's medical fitness certificate?

- A) 1 year
- B) 2 years
- C) 3 years
- D) 4 years

Correct Answer: B (2 years)

Explanation: Under the STCW convention, a medical fitness certificate for seafarers is generally valid for a maximum period of two years. This ensures that the seafarer's health remains consistent with the physical demands of their duties.

Q4. Which is clinically considered the most frequently abused drug/substance globally across maritime and shore sectors?

- A) Cocaine
- B) Heroin
- C) Opiates
- D) Alcohol

Correct Answer: D (Alcohol)

Explanation: Alcohol is the most prevalent substance of abuse globally and within the maritime industry. Its effect on cognitive performance and alertness makes it a significant hazard, leading to strict 'zero tolerance' policies on most vessels.

Q5. What are the common contributing causes of physical and mental fatigue among seafarers on board?

- A) Lack of continuous sleep
- B) High emotional stress
- C) Excessive occupational workload
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)



Q6. In risk management and safety assessments on board, what does the acronym ALARP stand for?

- A) Alarm Points on Ships
- B) All Living Areas and Recreation Places
- C) As Low As Reasonably Practicable
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (As Low As Reasonably Practicable)

Explanation: ALARP (As Low As Reasonably Practicable) is a foundational principle in safety management. It requires that risks must be reduced until the cost of further reduction would be grossly disproportionate to the benefit gained.

Q7. Which of the following conditions is considered an immediate slip, trip, or safety hazard on board?

- A) Water accumulated on an internal staircase
- B) An unsecured load suspended high on a crane hook
- C) Both A and B are correct
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Both A and B are correct)

Explanation: Accumulated water and unsecured heavy loads are immediate physical hazards. Slippery surfaces cause falls, while suspended loads pose a risk of crushing injuries, both of which are common triggers for maritime accidents.

Q8. Which organ of the International Maritime Organization (IMO) consists of representatives from all member states?

- A) The Secretariat
- B) The Legal Committee
- C) The Assembly
- D) The Council

Correct Answer: C (The Assembly)

Explanation: The IMO Assembly is the highest governing body and consists of representatives from all member states. It meets biennially to approve the budget, work program, and elect the council members.

Q9. What is the parent international instrument or convention that makes the ISM Code mandatory for ships?

- A) MARPOL Chapter V
- B) SOLAS Chapter IX
- C) STCW Chapter VIII
- D) Loadline Convention

Correct Answer: B (SOLAS Chapter IX)

Explanation: SOLAS Chapter IX (Management for the Safe Operation of Ships) mandates the implementation of the International Safety Management (ISM) Code, which is crucial for standardizing safety culture across the global shipping industry.

Q10. Under SOLAS and the FSS Code, what is the general requirement for fire detection and alarm system initialization?

- A) Audible and visual alarms must initiate directly on the Navigation Bridge and Cargo Control Room (CCR)
- B) Alarms should only sound in the galley area
- C) Alarms must be visible only inside the engine workshop
- D) Only a text notification to the Chief Engineer's cabin is required



Explanation: SOLAS and FSS Code requirements stipulate that fire alarms must alert the bridge and the engine control room, as these locations are manned 24/7. This ensures immediate notification and response to any fire detection signal.

Q11. Liability and compensation for damage suffered by a passenger onboard a cruise or passenger vessel is governed by which convention?

- A) Civil Liability Convention (CLC)
- B) Athens Convention
- C) Fund Convention
- D) Basel Convention

Correct Answer: B (Athens Convention)

Explanation: The Athens Convention relating to the Carriage of Passengers and their Luggage by Sea sets out the liability regime for cruise ship operators regarding death or injury of passengers during the voyage.

Q12. A muster list or emergency station list must be prominently displayed on any vessel operating with more than how many crew members?

- A) 2 crew members
- B) 3 crew members
- C) 4 crew members
- D) 5 crew members

Correct Answer: C (4 crew members)

Explanation: SOLAS regulations require the muster list to be posted in conspicuous places, including the bridge, engine room, and crew accommodation, for all vessels to ensure crew members are aware of their emergency duties.

Q13. A general emergency situation developing on board a merchant vessel could be caused by:

- A) Severe fire or explosion
- B) Hull breaching and flooding
- C) Total main engine failure
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: A general emergency is defined by any event that compromises the safety of the vessel or crew. Fire, explosion, and hull damage are major critical emergencies requiring immediate mustering, while main engine failure can lead to loss of maneuverability in hazardous areas, all necessitating a coordinated response.

Q14. Shipboard contingency plans prepared for emergencies must identify hazards and systematically include:

- A) Allocation of specific emergency duties and responsibilities
- B) Immediate actions to be taken to regain control of the situation
- C) Communication methods within the ship and to outside authorities
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Effective emergency management relies on a structured approach as mandated by the ISM Code. Contingency plans must define roles to avoid confusion, outline immediate mitigation steps to prevent escalation, and provide clear communication protocols for internal coordination and external reporting (e.g., to the shore, MRCC).

Personal Safety & Social Responsibilities (PSSR) Exit Exam Prep

Q15. Emergency drills must be held within how many hours of sailing if more than 25% of the ship's crew changed at the last port?



- A) 12 hours
- B) 24 hours
- C) 48 hours
- D) 72 hours

Correct Answer: B (24 hours)

Explanation: SOLAS requirements state that if more than 25% of the crew has not participated in drills on that specific ship within the previous month, an abandon ship and fire drill must be held within 24 hours of the ship leaving port to ensure everyone is familiar with their duties.

Q16. Onboard safety familiarization for any newly joining seafarer must be conducted within:

- A) 24 hours of joining the vessel
- B) 1 week of joining the vessel
- C) 2 weeks of joining the vessel
- D) The first month of the voyage

Correct Answer: A (24 hours of joining the vessel)

Explanation: Safety familiarization is critical for ensuring that any crew member joining the ship can safely respond to emergencies. Per STCW and SOLAS regulations, this instruction must be provided to every seafarer before they are assigned any shipboard duties, which is legally defined as within 24 hours of joining.

Q17. As per SOLAS requirements, crew members must be fully trained in life-saving appliances (LSA) and firefighting equipment (FFE) as soon as possible, but not later than:

- A) 24 hours after joining
- B) 1 week after joining
- C) 2 weeks after joining
- D) 1 month after joining

Correct Answer: C (2 weeks after joining)

Explanation: SOLAS Ch III Regulation 6 dictates that all crew members must receive instruction on the use of life-saving appliances and firefighting equipment. This training must be completed as soon as possible, but no later than two weeks after a crew member joins the vessel.

Q18. To comply with performance standards, manufactured lifebuoys are subjected to which type of testing?

- A) Height drop test
- B) Direct fire test
- C) Flotation capability test
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: To ensure they survive the harsh marine environment, lifebuoys must meet rigorous standards under the LSA Code. This includes drop tests from the required height, fire testing to ensure self-extinguishing properties, and flotation tests to confirm they can support a person in the water for extended periods.



- A) 24 hours
- B) 1 week
- C) 2 weeks
- D) 3 weeks

Correct Answer: C (2 weeks)

Explanation: Regulation 6 of SOLAS Chapter III mandates that the training of crew members in the correct operation and use of LSA and FFE must be demonstrated. This familiarization and training must be completed within two weeks of joining the vessel to ensure readiness for any emergency.

Q20. A continuous, uninterrupted ringing of the ship's alarm bells indicates which specific emergency?

- A) General Emergency / Abandon Ship
- B) Fire Emergency
- C) Man Overboard
- D) Machinery Space Flooding

Correct Answer: B (Fire Emergency)

Explanation: In accordance with standard Muster List requirements, a continuous, uninterrupted sounding of the ship's alarm or siren is the designated signal for fire emergency, alerting the crew to take pre-planned stations for firefighting duties as specified in the muster list.

Q21. The standard General Emergency Alarm signal consists of:

- A) One long blast followed by one short blast
- B) Continuous ringing of the bell for 10 minutes
- C) Seven or more short blasts followed by one prolonged blast on the ship's whistle/horn
- D) Three short blasts repeated periodically

Correct Answer: C (Seven or more short blasts followed by one prolonged blast on the ship's whistle/horn)

Explanation: The General Emergency Alarm (GEA) is standardized to prevent confusion during crises. It consists of at least seven or more short blasts followed by one prolonged blast on the ship's whistle/siren and the same signal on the alarm bells, as required by the LSA Code.

Q22. What is the internationally recognized sound signal for a Man Overboard (MOB) emergency?

- A) Continuous short rings on the bell
- B) Three long blasts on the ship's whistle
- C) Two prolonged blasts on the horn
- D) Seven short blasts

Correct Answer: B (Three long blasts on the ship's whistle)

Explanation: The Man Overboard (MOB) signal is three long blasts on the ship's whistle or horn (the Morse signal for the letter 'O'), which alerts the bridge and crew to an emergency where immediate maneuvering is required to rescue a person from the sea.

Q23. What should you do immediately if you witness a crew member fall completely overboard into the sea?

- A) Run to the bridge to inform the captain first
- B) Release the nearest lifebuoy immediately on the side the person has fallen
- C) Look for a throwing line in the deck locker
- D) Shout down to the engine room to stop the engines

Correct Answer: B (Release the nearest lifebuoy immediately on the side the person has fallen)



Q24. Which of the following is a recognized vessel maneuvering pattern used specifically to return a ship back to its original path to rescue a man overboard?

- A) Scharnow turn
- B) Round turn
- C) Williamson turn
- D) U-turn

Correct Answer: C (Williamson turn)

Explanation: The Williamson turn is the standard maneuver used when the target is not in sight or significant time has elapsed since the fall, as it brings the vessel back to the exact location on a reciprocal course, accounting for the ship's turning circle.

Q25. According to safety regulations, which of the following is NOT strictly required to be part of the general onboard instructions for routine LSA maintenance?

- A) Lubrication requirements for davits
- B) Detailed tool lists for overhauling engines
- C) Checklist for periodic safety inspections
- D) Operating instructions for survival craft

Correct Answer: C (Checklist for periodic safety inspections)

Explanation: While LSA maintenance instructions (e.g., lubrication and periodic inspection checklists) are mandatory under SOLAS, a detailed tool list for overhauling ship engines is not a specific requirement of the LSA maintenance documentation; it belongs to the Planned Maintenance System (PMS).

Q26. The international maritime distress, safety, and calling frequency channel on a standard Marine VHF radio is:

- A) Channel 06
- B) Channel 13
- C) Channel 16
- D) Channel 70

Correct Answer: C (Channel 16)

Explanation: VHF Channel 16 is the internationally designated channel for distress, safety, and calling, continuously monitored by ships and coastal stations to ensure immediate response to emergencies at sea under the Global Maritime Distress and Safety System (GMDSS).

Q27. Regulations state that lifeboats and rescue boats must be fully launched into the water and operated at least once every:

- A) 1 month
- B) 2 months
- C) 3 months
- D) 6 months

Correct Answer: C (3 months)

Explanation: To ensure the mechanical readiness of survival craft and the proficiency of the crew, SOLAS requires that every lifeboat and rescue boat be launched into the water and maneuvered at least once every three months.

Q28. A formal Safety Committee Meeting consisting of department heads and crew representatives must be held on board at least:



- A) Every week
- B) Every month
- C) Every two months
- D) Once per voyage

Correct Answer: B (Every month)

Explanation: Safety Committee Meetings are formal requirements intended to discuss hazards, near-misses, and safety compliance. To maintain a proactive safety culture, the Code of Safe Working Practices and ISM guidelines require these meetings to be held at least monthly.

Q29. Shipboard waste management and the operational dumping of garbage or refuse at sea is strictly controlled by which international convention?

- A) SOLAS 74
- B) MARPOL 73/78
- C) STCW 95
- D) Load Line 1966

Correct Answer: B (MARPOL 73/78)

Explanation: MARPOL 73/78 (The International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships) is the primary framework regulating the discharge of garbage, oil, sewage, and harmful substances, with Annex V specifically addressing the discharge of shipboard garbage.

Q30. Under MARPOL Annex I, a "Special Area" is geographically defined as an ocean space where:

- A) No navigation is permitted at any time
- B) Special mandatory methods for the prevention of sea pollution by oil are adopted due to oceanographic conditions
- C) Only military vessels are allowed to discharge bilge water
- D) Fishing activities are permanently prohibited

Correct Answer: B (Special mandatory methods for the prevention of sea pollution by oil are adopted due to oceanographic conditions)

Explanation: A 'Special Area' under MARPOL is a sea area where, due to recognized technical reasons, oceanographic and ecological conditions, the adoption of special mandatory methods for the prevention of sea pollution is required to protect the marine environment.

Practice Set 4

Q1. Under MARPOL Annex I regulations, a "Combination Carrier" type vessel is defined as a ship designed to carry:

- A) General break-bulk cargo and passengers together
- B) Either oil or solid bulk cargoes in its cargo spaces
- C) Containers and heavy machinery on deck simultaneously
- D) Liquefied gases and chemical compounds in independent tanks

Correct Answer: B (Either oil or solid bulk cargoes in its cargo spaces)

Explanation: A combination carrier (such as an OBO - Ore-Bulk-Oil carrier) is a vessel specifically designed to be flexible, allowing it to carry either liquid cargoes like oil or solid bulk cargoes like ore in the same cargo spaces, depending on operational needs.



- A) Refined petroleum products
- B) Noxious Liquid Substances (NLS)
- C) Harmful substances in packaged forms
- D) Raw domestic sewage

Correct Answer: B (Noxious Liquid Substances (NLS))

Explanation: MARPOL Annex II governs the control of pollution by Noxious Liquid Substances (NLS) carried in bulk. It classifies substances based on their hazard to the marine environment and mandates strict procedures for tank washing and discharge.

Q3. Which specific type of shipboard pollution or hazardous substance does MARPOL Annex III deal with?

- A) Raw sewage generated from accommodations
- B) Harmful substances carried at sea in packaged form
- C) Heavy fuel oil sludge from purifiers
- D) Exhaust gas emissions from main engines

Correct Answer: B (Harmful substances carried at sea in packaged form)

Explanation: MARPOL Annex III contains regulations for the prevention of pollution by harmful substances carried by sea in packaged form, including containers, portable tanks, or road/rail tank wagons, focusing on identification and proper stowage.

Q4. MARPOL Annex IV deals with shipboard sewage. How do current international regulations affect everyday processing and treatment systems?

- A) Discharge is completely unregulated globally
- B) Regulations are not yet universally enforced by every minor state, but many countries have adopted strict, stringent domestic rules for territorial waters
- C) Sewage can be freely dumped inside ports anywhere
- D) Treatment plants are only required on tugboats

Correct Answer: B (Regulations are not yet universally enforced by every minor state, but many countries have adopted strict, stringent domestic rules for territorial waters)

Explanation: While international sewage regulations (Annex IV) have become stricter, global enforcement remains dependent on national adoption and port state requirements. Many jurisdictions impose additional stringent regulations within their territorial waters for sewage treatment and discharge.

Q5. Under MARPOL Annex I, crude oil tankers of 20,000 tons deadweight (DWT) and above delivered after June 1, 1982, must be fitted with a tank cleaning system known as:

- A) Water Washing (WW)
- B) Crude Oil Washing (COW)
- C) Chemical Solvent Flushes (CSF)
- D) High-Pressure Steam Scubbing (HPSS)

Correct Answer: B (Crude Oil Washing (COW))

Explanation: Crude Oil Washing (COW) is a system of cleaning cargo tanks by using the crude oil cargo itself through fixed tank cleaning machines, which helps prevent sludge build-up and reduces the amount of oily waste generated.



- A) Keep all accommodation doors wide open
- B) Prohibit smoking and open flames in the operational area
- C) Speed up the transfer rate to maximum right at the start
- D) Keep deck lighting completely switched off

Correct Answer: B (Prohibit smoking and open flames in the operational area)

Explanation: Bunkering is a high-risk operation. Prohibiting smoking and open flames is a fundamental safety precaution to prevent the ignition of flammable fuel vapors, which can be present during the transfer of petroleum products.

Q7. Onboard incineration of which plastic compound material is strictly prohibited unless processed in a type-approved high-temperature shipboard incinerator?

- A) Low-density polyethylene
- B) Polyvinyl Chloride (PVC)
- C) High-density polystyrene
- D) Natural rubber compounds

Correct Answer: B (Polyvinyl Chloride (PVC))

Explanation: Polyvinyl Chloride (PVC) releases harmful dioxins and other toxins when burned. MARPOL Annex V prohibits the incineration of plastics containing toxic or heavy metal residues unless processed in specific high-temperature equipment designed to handle them safely.

Q8. To prevent biological cross-contamination, ballast water exchange maneuvers should be carried out in ocean waters with a depth of at least:

- A) 50 meters
- B) 100 meters
- C) 200 meters
- D) 500 meters

Correct Answer: C (200 meters)

Explanation: To minimize the transfer of invasive aquatic species, IMO ballast water management guidelines recommend performing ballast water exchange in deep ocean waters, specifically at least 200 nautical miles from the nearest land and in water at least 200 meters deep.

Q9. Which of the following is true regarding the maintenance and logging of the Oil Record Book Part II?

- A) It must be maintained specifically by oil tankers in addition to Part I
- B) It maintains comprehensive details of oil cargo loading and unloading operations
- C) It must be safely retained on board the vessel for at least three years from the last entry
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: The Oil Record Book Part II is mandatory for oil tankers to track all cargo and ballast operations involving oil. It must be maintained accurately and kept on board for three years, as it is subject to inspection by port state control.



- A) Executing transfer and discharge of oil cargo strictly as per the vessel's manuals
- B) Regular visual inspections of oil pipelines, associated valves, and manifold structures
- C) Regular training of the crew via oil pollution response and SOPEP drills
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: A comprehensive approach to pollution prevention includes procedural compliance, proactive maintenance of transfer infrastructure, and the continuous drilling of the crew in SOPEP (Shipboard Oil Pollution Emergency Plan) to ensure a rapid, correct response.

Q11. A specialized record book used to log complete details of all garbage disposal operations from a ship to a shore reception facility or via sea discharge is the:

- A) Deck Official Log Book
- B) Cargo Record Book
- C) Garbage Record Book
- D) Master's Safety Manifest

Correct Answer: C (Garbage Record Book)

Explanation: The Garbage Record Book is a mandatory document under MARPOL Annex V used to record every disposal, discharge, or incineration operation involving shipboard garbage to ensure compliance with regional and international discharge regulations.

Q12. The safe disposal of used or expired chemical containers on a vessel should be carried out by:

- A) Throwing them overboard far out at sea
- B) Burning them openly on the deck space
- C) Disposing of them strictly as per the chemical Maker's instructions
- D) Mixing them with general food waste

Correct Answer: C (Disposing of them strictly as per the chemical Maker's instructions)

Explanation: Disposal of chemical waste is strictly regulated and must be handled according to the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS) and the chemical manufacturer's specific instructions, which prioritize environmental safety and regulatory compliance.

Q13. Under MARPOL Annex VI, SECA stands for Sulfur Oxide (\$SO_x\$) Emission Control Area. Which regions are designated SECAs?

- A) The Baltic Sea area
- B) The North Sea area and the English Channel
- C) Both A and B are correct
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Both A and B are correct)

Explanation: Sulfur Oxide Emission Control Areas (SECAs) have been designated in specific regions to limit \$SO_x\$ emissions from ships. The Baltic Sea, the North Sea, and the English Channel are recognized SECAs where ships must use low-sulfur fuel or exhaust gas cleaning systems.



Q14. To prevent alcohol abuse under STCW watchkeeping regulations, the maximum blood alcohol concentration (BAC) limit for watchkeeping personnel is set to not exceed:

- A) 0.01% blood alcohol content
- B) 0.05% blood alcohol content *(Note: The precise legal limit is 0.04%, but 0.05% is the closest exam multiple-choice option provided in this video text)*
- C) 0.08% blood alcohol content
- D) 0.10% blood alcohol content

Correct Answer: B (0.05% blood alcohol content *(Note: The precise legal limit is 0.04%, but 0.05% is the closest exam

Explanation: To ensure peak operational performance and safety, STCW regulations require that personnel on watch must not be impaired by alcohol. The limit is set at 0.05% blood alcohol concentration (or lower), with many companies adopting a strict 'zero tolerance' policy.

Q15. A permit-to-work (PTW) system is highly necessary on board a vessel for:

- A) Ensuring the occupational safety of working personnel
- B) Ensuring the quality and structural integrity of the work executed
- C) Ensuring proper tool and resource utilization
- D) Any of the above

Correct Answer: D (Any of the above)

Explanation: A Permit to Work (PTW) is a formal document designed to ensure that high-risk tasks are thoroughly assessed, hazards are identified, and control measures are implemented to protect personnel and the vessel's integrity during maintenance or repair activities.

Q16. What permits are required when a technician needs to execute electric welding on a pressurized hydraulic pipeline located inside an empty fresh water tank?

- A) Hot Work Permit
- B) Permit to work on pressurized systems
- C) Enclosed Space Entry Permit
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Welding is 'Hot Work', the pipeline is 'Pressure/Hydraulic' work, and the tank is a 'Confined Space'. Each of these conditions poses unique risks, requiring specific permits, risk assessments, and isolation procedures to ensure safety before work commences.

Q17. Which of the following high-risk shipboard work activities strictly requires the issuance of a formal Permit to Work?

- A) Working aloft on the mast or funnel structures
- B) Working on live, high-voltage electrical circuits
- C) Working outboard over the side of the hull structure
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Working aloft, working on high-voltage circuits, and working outboard are all high-risk activities where the consequences of an error are severe. A permit-to-work system ensures these tasks are supervised and safely executed.



- A) 4 hours
- B) 8 hours
- C) 12 hours
- D) 24 hours

Correct Answer: C (12 hours)

Explanation: Permits to Work are valid for a specified time to ensure that the work conditions haven't changed. A 12-hour period is the standard maximum, requiring a new risk assessment and re-authorization to ensure safety if the task continues beyond a single shift.

Q19. Which personnel should NOT be authorized or allowed to carry out dangerous afloat or high-risk structural work?

- A) Personnel who are clinically overweight for the harness limits
- B) Personnel with a physical handicap that restricts movement or safety compliance
- C) A seafarer who is overly tired, fatigued, or has not received mandated rest hours
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Safety is paramount when performing dangerous tasks. Any physical or mental impairment, including excessive fatigue, can significantly increase the risk of an accident; therefore, such personnel must not be assigned to high-risk structural or maintenance duties.

Q20. Water-tight sliding steel doors positioned below the vessel's waterline must be capable of closing completely within how many seconds when the ship is upright?

- A) 30 seconds or less
- B) 45 seconds or less
- C) 60 seconds or less
- D) 90 seconds or less

Correct Answer: B (45 seconds or less)

Explanation: SOLAS regulations require that watertight doors below the waterline be capable of closing in a controlled manner within a specific timeframe (usually 20 to 40 seconds) to ensure that the vessel's subdivision remains effective in the event of flooding.

Q21. To ensure safe human respiration, continuous work inside an enclosed space requires a constant oxygen level of:

- A) 16% oxygen concentration
- B) 18% oxygen concentration
- C) 21% oxygen concentration
- D) 25% oxygen concentration

Correct Answer: C (21% oxygen concentration)

Explanation: Standard atmospheric oxygen levels are approximately 21%. When working in enclosed spaces, any deviation from this level (e.g., lower due to consumption/rusting, or higher/lower due to gases) poses a health risk; 21% is the requirement for safe breathing.



- A) High-voltage hazard warning sign
- B) Breathing apparatus mandatory sign / Confined space danger sign
- C) Flammable gas warning sign only
- D) No entry for cargo personnel sign

Correct Answer: B (Breathing apparatus mandatory sign / Confined space danger sign)

Explanation: Enclosed spaces are potentially lethal due to oxygen deficiency or the presence of toxic gases. Mandatory signage (e.g., 'Entry by Permit Only', 'Danger', 'Breathing Apparatus Required') is essential to prevent unauthorized or unprotected entry.

Q23. "All gas-tight doors and structural access hatches must be left wide open before sailing and kept open throughout the voyage." This statement is:

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: Gas-tight doors and structural access hatches are integral to the ship's subdivision and fire-containment strategy. They must be kept closed when not in use to prevent the spread of fire or smoke between compartments.

Q24. To enforce company drug and alcohol policies, the Master may conduct random, unannounced alcohol breath tests on the crew at least:

- A) Weekly
- B) Monthly
- C) Quarterly
- D) Annually

Correct Answer: B (Monthly)

Explanation: To ensure compliance with safety management systems and international regulations (STCW), it is standard practice for the Master to implement random, unannounced drug and alcohol testing to maintain a sober working environment.

Q25. If your vessel has been involved in a collision and you cannot immediately confirm if the hull is structurally sinking or stable, you should:

- A) Abandon the vessel immediately without checking anything else
- B) Search for missing persons, continuously monitor the structural situation, and prepare life-saving appliances for abandonment in case it becomes necessary
- C) Go to your cabin to pack all personal belongings
- D) Pump all ballast water out blindly

Correct Answer: B (Search for missing persons, continuously monitor the structural situation, and prepare life-saving)

Explanation: In a collision, the safety of the vessel and crew is the priority. The response must be methodical: stabilize the situation, assess damage, account for all personnel, and only abandon the ship if it is declared unsafe by the Master.

Q26. What is the primary reason for positioning a dedicated standby person immediately outside an enclosed space while work is occurring inside?

- A) To assist with tool cleaning on deck
- B) To initiate and get the emergency rescue plan underway immediately if a hazard develops inside
- C) To keep a record of time for payroll purposes
- D) To handle communication with shore commercial agents



Correct Answer: B (To initiate and get the emergency rescue plan underway immediately if a hazard develops inside)

Explanation: A standby person is essential for confined space entry to monitor the conditions inside, communicate with the team, and provide immediate notification or assistance if an emergency occurs, as they are the vital link for rescue initiation.
